MODULE 15 · SECTION 2 - GOOGLE CLOUD'S GEN AI OFFERINGS

Agent Platform for builders: Model Garden, Agent Studio and AutoML

Where teams choose models, design and test prompts, train custom models without code, and move a prototype into production.

SECTION 2 of 4 EXAM WEIGHT ~35% MODULE 15 of 33

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Agent Platform is the workshop where teams **build AI into their own products**, with enterprise controls from day one.

Agent Platform as a restaurant kitchen

PART	IN A RESTAURANT KITCHEN
Model Garden	The pantry: over 200 ingredients
Agent Studio	The test kitchen: try, taste, adjust
AutoML	The bread machine: good results, no chef
ADK and Agent Runtime	The production line (module 18)
Model Registry and Monitoring	The inspector (module 6)

REMEMBER

Choosing a model, testing prompts, or training without code: three different rooms of the same kitchen.

Agent Platform: one governed home for builders

- **Formerly Vertex AI;** renamed Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform in April 2026.
- **Build:** Model Garden, Agent Studio, the Agent Development Kit.
- **Scale:** Agent Runtime, endpoints and dedicated capacity.
- **Govern and optimise:** identity, security, evaluation and monitoring.
- **Enterprise controls:** IAM, private networking, data residency, SLAs.

ON THE EXAM

One platform to build, deploy, govern and monitor models and agents: Agent Platform, or Vertex AI on older papers.

Gemini Enterprise or Agent Platform?

GEMINI ENTERPRISE

An app for employees

- Formerly Agentspace
- Search, assistant, agents
- Staff use it every day
- Little or no code

AGENT PLATFORM

A platform for builders

- Formerly Vertex AI
- Models, prompts, tuning, agents
- Developers and data teams
- Builds into your own products

THE TIEBREAKER

Two names, two words apart. Ask whether people use it or teams build with it.

Model Garden: the pantry

- **Discover** more than 200 models in one catalogue.
- **Google's own,** such as Gemini, Gemma, Veo and Chirp.
- **Partner and open models,** such as Anthropic's Claude and Llama.
- **Model cards** describe each model's uses, limits and licence.
- **Test, customise and deploy:** call managed APIs, or deploy to your own endpoint.

> THE SIGNAL
>
> Find, compare and deploy models, including non-Google ones: Model Garden.

Agent Studio: the test kitchen

- **Formerly Vertex AI Studio;** a shared workspace in your Google Cloud project.
- **Design prompts** and system instructions, and refine them.
- **Compare** models and instructions side by side.
- **Ground** answers in Google Search, Maps, Agent Search or RAG Engine.
- **Tune models,** design agents on a low-code canvas, deploy a prompt as an app.

THE SIGNAL

Design, test and compare prompts and agents, inside the company's governed project: Agent Studio.

Ways to adapt a model on Agent Platform

METHOD	WHAT IT DOES
Prompt design	Better instructions; no training at all
Grounding	Connects your data at answer time
Supervised fine-tuning	Labelled examples teach a task or style
Preference tuning	Learns which answers people prefer
Prompt tuning	Learns a small prompt; model stays frozen

REMEMBER

Climb the module 9 ladder: prompt first, then ground, then tune. Section 3 goes deeper.

AutoML: the bread machine

- **Train a custom model** on your own labelled data, without code.
- **You supply** the labelled examples; AutoML chooses and tunes the model.
- **Images:** classify photos, or find objects in them.
- **Tables:** classify, predict a number, or forecast.
- **AutoML for text and video ended in 2025;** Gemini now handles those.

> THE SIGNAL
>
> Your own labelled images or tables, a custom prediction, and no ML experts: AutoML.

AutoML or a foundation model?

AUTOML

A narrow, trained specialist

- Your labelled images or tables
- One fixed prediction
- Consistent and cheap at volume
- Needs labelled data first

FOUNDATION MODEL

A broad, ready generalist

- No training to start
- Writes, summarises, extracts
- Prompt it today, tune later
- Wording varies run to run

THE TIEBREAKER

Predict a fixed label or number from your own history: AutoML. Generate or understand language and images broadly: a foundation model.

Google AI Studio or Agent Studio?

GOOGLE AI STUDIO

Fast start for developers

- Google account and an API key
- Google's models, global endpoint
- Free tier may improve Google products
- No SLA, no MLOps

AGENT STUDIO

Enterprise build and run

- Cloud project, IAM, service accounts
- Data residency and private networking
- Data never used to improve products
- SLAs, support, Model Garden, MLOps

THE TIEBREAKER

Quick prototype or personal experiment: Google AI Studio. Company data, regulation or production: Agent Studio on Agent Platform.

From a personal key to production

IN THE PROTOTYPE	IN PRODUCTION
A personal API key	Service account, controlled by IAM
Free tier; data may improve products	Agent Platform terms; never used
One global endpoint	A UK region, for data residency
No service level	SLA and enterprise support
Prompt built in Google AI Studio	Same SDK, new client setup

THE TAKEAWAY

The code mostly carries over; the controls change. Then delete the old personal key.

Phrases that point to each tool

THE QUESTION SAYS	CHOOSE
"Compare and deploy models, partners too"	Model Garden
"Test prompts, compare models, low-code agents"	Agent Studio
"Labelled images or tables, no code"	AutoML
"Quick prototype with an API key"	Google AI Studio
"Production with IAM, residency and SLAs"	Agent Platform
"Employees search and use agents"	Gemini Enterprise

ON THE EXAM

Older papers say Vertex AI, Vertex AI Studio and Vertex AI Model Garden. Same answers, older names.

> Wrenfield's data team wants to compare Gemma, Llama and Anthropic's Claude for tagging new products.
>
> They want to test all three, read each model's limits and licence, and deploy the winner, all in one governed place.

Which offering fits best?

A Google AI Studio

B Model Garden on Agent Platform

C The Agent Gallery in Gemini Enterprise

D AutoML

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which offering fits best?

A Google AI Studio

Google's models only, with no enterprise governance.

B Model Garden on Agent Platform

One catalogue of Google, partner and open models, with model cards.

C The Agent Gallery in Gemini Enterprise

Lists agents for employees, not models for builders.

D AutoML

Trains a new model; it does not offer these three.

THE SIGNAL

Compare and deploy many models, including partners: Model Garden.

> Wrenfield's product-copy tool was prototyped in Google AI Studio with a developer's personal API key.
>
> Leadership wants it in production, with security approval, UK data residency and a service level agreement.

What should the leader recommend?

A Stay in Google AI Studio and upgrade to the paid tier

B Share the developer's key with the whole team

C Rebuild it on Wrenfield's own servers with an open model

D Move it to Agent Platform, with service accounts and a UK region

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the leader recommend?

A Stay in Google AI Studio and upgrade to the paid tier

Still an API key and a global endpoint, with no SLA.

B Share the developer's key with the whole team

Spreads a personal secret, with no control or audit.

C Rebuild it on Wrenfield's own servers with an open model

A large rebuild, and new servers to run.

D Move it to Agent Platform, with service accounts and a UK region

IAM, regional data residency and an SLA, with the code mostly reused.

THE SIGNAL

Prototype to regulated production: Agent Platform.

> Wrenfield holds 60,000 product photos, each labelled with one of 40 product types.
>
> The quality team wants every new photo sorted into those 40 types, consistently and cheaply, at high volume. Nobody on the team writes code.

Which approach fits best?

A Prompt Gemini with each photo and the list of types

B Train a model from scratch with custom code

C AutoML, trained on the labelled photos

D Deep Research in the Gemini app

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which approach fits best?

A Prompt Gemini with each photo and the list of types

A fair pilot, but costlier and less consistent at volume.

B Train a model from scratch with custom code

Needs ML engineers the team does not have.

C AutoML, trained on the labelled photos

A custom image classifier from their labels, without code.

D Deep Research in the Gemini app

Researches the web; it does not sort photos.

THE SIGNAL

Labelled images, one fixed prediction, no code: AutoML.

> A Wrenfield product manager, who does not write code, is shaping the returns assistant.
>
> She wants to try different system instructions and compare Gemini Flash and Pro answers side by side. She also wants to ground answers in Agent Search, inside the company's Google Cloud project.

Which tool fits best?

A Agent Studio on Agent Platform

B Google AI Studio, with her personal account

C The Agent Development Kit, in Python

D Model Registry

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which tool fits best?

A Agent Studio on Agent Platform

Prompts, side-by-side comparison and grounding, in the governed project.

B Google AI Studio, with her personal account

Outside the company project and its controls.

C The Agent Development Kit, in Python

A code-first kit, and she does not write code.

D Model Registry

Tracks model versions; it does not test prompts.

THE SIGNAL

Design and compare prompts inside the company project: Agent Studio.

> A Wrenfield developer wants to try the newest Gemini model this afternoon for a personal hackathon project.
>
> It uses no company data, and she wants to start for free in minutes.

Which option fits best?

A Agent Platform, with private networking and dedicated capacity

B AutoML

C Gemini Enterprise

D Google AI Studio

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which option fits best?

A Agent Platform, with private networking and dedicated capacity

Powerful, but heavy setup for an afternoon experiment.

B AutoML

Trains a model; it does not offer Gemini to try.

C Gemini Enterprise

An employee app, not a developer sandbox.

D Google AI Studio

Fast, free start with an API key. No company data involved.

THE SIGNAL

A quick, personal prototype with no company data: Google AI Studio.

> Wrenfield's board wants one place where its developers keep models, prompts, tuning jobs, deployed agents and monitoring.
>
> Everything must sit under the company's access controls.

Which offering fits best?

A Gemini Enterprise

B Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform

C Google AI Studio

D Google Workspace

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which offering fits best?

A Gemini Enterprise

An app for employees, not a home for builders' work.

B Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform

One governed platform to build, deploy and monitor.

C Google AI Studio

A developer sandbox, with no enterprise governance.

D Google Workspace

Productivity apps, not a platform for models.

THE SIGNAL

One governed home for builders: Agent Platform, formerly Vertex AI.

Module 15 in five lines

- Agent Platform, formerly Vertex AI: the governed workshop for builders.
- Model Garden: discover, test and deploy 200+ models, including partners.
- Agent Studio: design, compare, ground and tune; low-code agents.
- AutoML: custom image and table models from your labels, without code.
- Google AI Studio to prototype; Agent Platform for company data and production.